

Town of Westhampton
Town Hall
1 South Road
Westhampton, Massachusetts 01027

Finance Committee Meeting Minutes
Tuesday, March 4, 2014

The meeting convened at 7:00 PM

Present:

Finance Committee Members: Ellice Gonzalez, Ed Zawacki, Margaret Parsons, Aniko Giordano, Joe Pipczynski, Celeste Whiting, Maryanne Duggan, Mary Cleary.
Additional Attendee: Cheryl Baldasaro, Administrative Assistant.

1. The Finance Committee voted 8-0-0 to approve Mary Cleary to serve as secretary of the Finance Committee.
2. We discussed the schedule for the upcoming meetings. The schedules are as follows:

March 18: Meet with the Police Department at 7:30

March 25: Meet with Selectboard at 7:00, Highway Department at 7:30,
Fire Department at 8:00

Also regarding schedules we discussed and agreed that our future meetings will begin at 6:45 instead of 7:00.

3. Budget: We reviewed the draft FY2015 preliminary budget (see attached). Cheryl noted that the numbers in italics are the updated numbers. We briefly discussed the following items from the preliminary budget:

Line 42: Noted that the Vocational Tuition for FY15 amount is down from FY14. Will there be a surplus from FY14?

Line 77: Regarding Health Agent, Cheryl explained that this is pending acceptance into the Foothills Health District in an effort to regionalize the health agent position for cost cutting, retention and availability of health agent.

Line 73: There is currently a proposal to add an animal control/inspector to the town budget. Currently, Rick Tracy serves the role of animal inspector. We noted that Westhampton currently lacks leash laws and that there may be a moved toward including a dog-at-large bylaw.

Not a line item: Cheryl noted that there is not yet a line for the elevator inspection, but that is needed.

Other items that may come up included items from the Capital Planning meeting (set for tomorrow) and funds for Fire Department's SCUBA gear (Chris Norris has applied for a

grant for this). We noted that Free Cash for the FY15 revenue is listed as \$0 in the hopes that we will not use any of the Free Cash for FY15. There is currently \$201,723 in Free Cash.

4. Review of Dec. 18th FinCom Meeting: FinCom moved to amend the Dec. 18 minutes to list Celeste Whiting as present at the meeting, and removed one of the Mary Clearys, which was listed twice. FinCom voted 8-0-0 to accept the minutes as amended.

We noted that in the special town election, the school roof project passed 77-11. We reviewed the discussion and process of the Dec. 18 meeting and noted the confusion the FinCom members felt regarding the procedure for voting on articles such as the school roof project. Ellice presented the committee with Town of Westhampton bylaw 5-3-7. Upon review and discussion, it is now the understanding of our members that proposed articles regarding town expenditures shall be drafted by the Selectboard and presented to the Finance Committee. The Finance Committee is not designated with the responsibility of drafting articles. We also noted some concern over the misrepresenting of Finance Committee votes.

5. Review correspondence: Noted that Finance Committee members are invited to the upcoming 2014 Hampshire and Franklin Municipal Conference on Saturday, April 12th.
6. Reviewed draft of Finance Committee Report for Annual Town Meeting Book. Noted that the OPEB Fund was *approved* by the voters (to be corrected in draft of report).
7. Reviewed 7 requests for funds by the following departments (see attached): Town Clerk, Treasurer, Board of Assessors, Fire Department, Veterans, Inspector Expense, Board of Health. FinCom would like to remind department heads to provide as much detail as possible in their requests so that we can understand their submissions as clearly as possible.
8. Ellice expressed gratitude to all for attending and giving their time to the Finance Committee.

Respectfully Submitted by Mary Cleary